
OCR GCSE IN ECONOMICS

1985

Key Features

- A clear progression route to the revised OCR AS/A Level Economics specifications.
- No coursework requirement.
- Case study paper based on pre-released scenario.
- Scenario covers key topics from subject content.
- List of web sites published to support investigation of the scenario.
- Scenario provides excellent vehicle for revision.
- Building on the successful current OCR GCSE in Economics.

Support and In-Service Training for Teachers

- A full programme of In-Service training meetings arranged by the Training and Customer Support Division (telephone 01223 552950).
- Specimen question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications Department (telephone 0870-870-6622, fax 0870-870-6621).
- Past question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications Department (telephone 0870-870-6622, fax 0870-870-6621).
- A report on the examination, compiled by senior examining personnel after each examination session.

CONTENTS

SECTION A: SPECIFICATION SUMMARY	5
SECTION B: GENERAL INFORMATION	7
1 Introduction	7
1.1 Rationale	7
1.2 Certification Title	7
1.3 Level of Qualification	8
1.4 Recommended Prior Learning	8
1.5 Progression	8
1.6 Overlap with Other Qualifications	8
1.7 Restrictions on Candidate Entries	9
1.8 Code of Practice Requirements	9
1.9 Status in Wales and Northern Ireland	9
2 Specification Aims	9
3 Assessment Objectives	10
4 Scheme of Assessment	10
4.1 Tiers	10
4.2 Components	11
4.3 Question Papers	11
4.4 Weighting of Assessment Objectives	12
4.5 Entry Options	12
4.6 Assessment of Written Communication and ICT	12
4.7 Differentiation	13
4.8 Awarding of Grades	13
4.9 Grade Descriptions	14

SECTION C: SPECIFICATION CONTENT	15
5 Specification Content	15
5.1 The Economic Problem	15
5.2 The Competitive Market	16
5.3 The Economic Role of Government within the UK	18
5.4 The European and International Setting	20
SECTION D: COURSEWORK	23
Not applicable to this course	
SECTION E: FURTHER INFORMATION	25
6 Opportunities for Teaching	25
6.1 ICT	25
6.2 Citizenship	26
6.3 Spiritual, Moral, Ethical, Social and Cultural Issues	28
6.4 Health, Safety and Environmental Issues	28
6.5 The European Dimension	28
7 Key Skills	29
8 Reading List	30
9 Arrangements for Candidates with Special Needs	31
10 Support and In-service Training for Teachers	31

Throughout the specification the following icons are used to signpost teaching and learning opportunities in:

 Citizenship

 ICT

 Key Skills

SECTION A: SPECIFICATION SUMMARY

TIERS

Grades	Foundation Tier G to C	Higher Tier D to A*
A*	Candidates take components 1 and 2	Candidates take components 3 and 4
A		
B		
C		
D		
E		
F		
G		

COMPONENTS

Component	Title	Duration	Weighting
1	Paper 1 - Foundation Tier	1 hour 30 minutes	50%
2	Paper 2 (Case Study Paper) Foundation Tier	1 hour 30 minutes	50%
3	Paper 3 - Higher Tier	1 hour 30 minutes	50%
4	Paper 4 (Case Study Paper) Higher Tier	1 hour 30 minutes	50%

QUESTION PAPERS

All candidates will enter for one tier and take two papers. There is no coursework component for this specification.

Papers 1 and 3 will consist of short answer and longer structured questions based on data. All questions will be compulsory.

Papers 2 and 4 will contain a series of compulsory questions (which again consist of short answer and longer structured questions) related to a common, pre-released case study.

There is no coursework component for this specification.

ENTRY OPTIONS

All candidates should be entered for 1985 with one of the following option codes:

Option Code	Title	Components
F	Foundation Tier	1, 2
H	Higher Tier	3, 4

SECTION B: GENERAL INFORMATION

1 Introduction

1.1 RATIONALE

This specification is consistent with the GCSE Criteria for Business Studies and Economics (QCA 2000).

The overall aim of this specification is to enable centres to develop a course which will encourage candidates to:

- think from an economic perspective;
- understand basic economic concepts and theories;
- apply these concepts and theories to a range of economic contexts;
- explain and evaluate the market economy and the economic role of government;
- explain and evaluate the influence of the European Union on UK economic activity.

The specification is also intended to provide candidates with:

- a knowledge of both micro-economics and macro-economics;
- the ability to understand a range of current economic issues and to study relevant data from local, national, European and international sources;
- the ability to look critically at the basic economic models relating to issues such as demand and supply analysis, the role of government and the influence of international factors.

The specification will provide a qualification which will be:

- an appropriate foundation for a GCE Advanced Subsidiary or GCE Advanced qualification in Economics, or related subjects;
- an appropriate entry qualification for a range of other courses available at the end of compulsory education;
- an appropriate entry qualification for employment and/or training at the end of compulsory education.

The specification assumes no previous knowledge or study of Economics.

OCR has taken great care in the preparation of this specification and assessment material to avoid bias of any kind.